

PUBLIC FACILITATION DESK

INTRODUCTION

Police is the most visible arm of the Government. A person in distress usually approaches police by calling emergency response numbers like '100' or rushes to a police station for redressal of grievances. A visitor to a police station as a complainant or otherwise certainly deserves to be heard and all he/she expects is an honest and sincere effort on the part of police to solve his/her problems..

2. At present, in every police station, there is a system wherein the complainants/visitors coming to the police stations are attended to by the Duty Officer, who listens/attends to them and brings their grievances to the notice of the concerned officers of the police station. However, the Duty Officer already has numerous other duties to take care of. Therefore, due to his pre-occupation in connection with his responsibilities as a "Duty Officer", most of the time he fails to appropriately attend to the complainants/visitors. Similarly, most of the time, SHO/IOs are not available in the police station due to their pre-occupation in other field/court duties and the complainants/visitors to the police stations find it very difficult to communicate with them. The ultimate result is loss of public faith in police functioning. With a view to fill the 'gap' and 'mis-trust' created due to lack of communication between the police and members of public, "Public Facilitation desk" in each police station is to be set-up which will act as the first point of contact and shall make the visit to a police station a satisfying and pleasurable experience for one and all.

3. **OBJECTIVES**

Public Facilitation Desk in the police stations is aimed to achieve the following objectives:-

1. Act as first point of contact for all visitors to the Police Station.
2. Enhance the quality of interaction between the public and the police personnel.
3. Facilitate general public to get answers for their queries in a systematic manner.
4. Streamline the process of handling different categories of 'Walk-ins' into the police stations.
5. Faster complaints redressal.
6. Elimination of harassment of complainants/visitors.
7. Making visit to the PS a pleasurable experience.

4. **DUTIES OF PUBLIC FACILITATION DESK OFFICER**

It will be the duty of the 'Public Facilitation Desk' Officer to attend to all the visitors and complainants who visit the police station for any purpose and ensure that their purpose of coming to the police station is achieved without any un-due delay in the best possible manner. A record of the details of the visitors and purpose of visit shall be maintained in a specially designed register in case his/her grievance cannot be addressed at that moment due to absence of an officer or for any other reason. He shall then inform the concerned officer of the police station (through a slip)

and arrange redressal of grievances of complainant/visitor. The concerned officer shall sign the carbon copy of the slip as an 'acknowledgment' that he has been duly intimated by the 'Public facilitation Desk' Officer. Thereafter, the concerned officer shall enter the action taken by him in the 'Public Facilitation Desk' register. The 'Public Facilitation Desk' Officer may give a feedback form to some complainants/visitors attended by him along with an envelope bearing printed address of the concerned SDPO and obtain his/her signature on the register for having received the same. This will help in identifying weak areas so as to continuously bring improvements in the system. The Public Facilitation Desk Register, Slip Book and the Feedback Forms shall be maintained by the 'Public Facilitation Desk' Officer as per Annexure I, II & III respectively. The 'Public Facilitation Desk' shall function on a 24x7 basis.

5. **RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE SHO**

- Shall arrange/provide the requisite display boards, stationery and furniture articles for setting up the 'Facilitation Desk' at a prominent place in the police station.
- Shall ensure that the 'Desk' remains operational always and is never left unattended at any point of time.
- Shall deploy staff on the 'Desk' after carefully selecting them on the basis of their ability to patiently and empathetically listen to the complainants/visitors with humaneness.
- Shall ensure that the staff identified for deployment at the 'Public Facilitation Desk' is also provided training to improve communication skills and to be empathetic.

- Shall monitor and maintain a record of resolved queries as well as follow up the un-resolved ones.

6. **TRAINING**

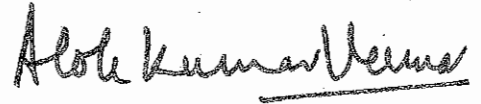
The key to successful functioning of Public Facilitation Desk depends on the staff deployed at the facilitation desk and their ability to handle the volume and variety of people and their queries. It is imperative that the staff entrusted with the responsibility of running the "Public Facilitation Desk" has the necessary 'empathy and 'communication skills' along with a thorough understanding of the process of grievance redressal mechanism. It shall be the responsibility of the concerned SDPOs to organize training workshops for Public Facilitation officers for their capacity building with the following objectives :-

- Handling the volume and variety of people and queries.
- Managing different types of people and personalities.
- Listening patiently and empathetically.
- Learning skills for facilitating people in managing their turbulent emotional or psychological state.
- Understanding of one's psyche and emotions.
- Managing stress and staying motivated.
- Enhancing counselling skills.
- Developing of inter-personal communication skills.

7. **SUPERVISION**

SHO shall supervise the functioning of the 'Public Facilitation Desk' on a day to day basis. He will keep a record of all the resolved queries & follow up all the un-resolved ones. ACP/Sub Division shall, during his visit

to the police station, closely monitor the functioning of the 'Public Facilitation Desk' at the ground level. SHO/ACP shall closely monitor the 'feedback' given by the complainants/visitors and use it as a tool to identify the problem areas and find solutions for them. District DCP shall periodically review the functioning of the 'Public Facilitation Desks'.



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